HOORVIA - MEAT THAWING SAFETY CHART: PRINTABLE SAFE DEFROST REFERENCE

Quick Reference Cheat Sheet · US Letter Printable

Kitchen & Cooking · Sheet #1

Meat	Fridge Thaw Time	Cold Water Thaw	Safety Rules
Chicken Breasts (1 lb)	1 day	1-2 hrs	Cook within 1-2 days of thawing
Whole Chicken (4-5 lbs)	2-3 days	4-5 hrs	Change water every 30 minutes
Ground Meat (1 lb)	1 day	1 hr	Cook within 1-2 days; never refreeze raw
Steaks (1-inch)	1 day	1-2 hrs	Refreeze only if fridge-thawed
Large Roast (4-5 lbs)	3-4 days	5-6 hrs	Keep below 40°F / 4°C at all times
Turkey (12-16 lbs)	3-4 days	6-8 hrs	Allow 24 hrs fridge per 4-5 lbs
Turkey (20-24 lbs)	5-6 days	10-12 hrs	Plan a full week ahead
Pork Chops	1 day	1-2 hrs	Sealed bag in cold water only
Fish Fillets (1 lb)	1 day	1 hr	Cook the same day it thaws
Shrimp (1 lb)	Overnight	20-30 mins	Cold running water is fastest
Bacon / Sausage	1 day	1 hr	Skip the microwave - it cooks edges
Casseroles / Meatballs	1-2 days	2-3 hrs	Reheat to 165°F / 74°C throughout

PRO TIP: Cold Water Rules: Submerge sealed meat in COLD water, never warm - warm water breeds bacteria on the surface. Change the water every 30 minutes to keep it safely cold.